

Hatfield of Oregon joined Democrat George McGovern of South Dakota to propose a stronger requirement: that all US forces be withdrawn by the end of 1971. Neither bill became law, but in June the Senate voted for a resolution to terminate the 1964 Tonkin Gulf Resolution upon which Johnson and Nixon had claimed authority to deploy US forces to Vietnam.

Campus chaos

Congress was not alone in its anger. The Cambodian incursion inflamed domestic opposition to the war that had been mounting since the Moratorium protests of late 1969. On hundreds of college campuses, antiwar voices called the incursion an invasion. Nixon intensified the outcry by calling students “bums.” One tragic outcome of this turmoil was at Kent State University, Ohio, where National Guardsmen opened fire on protesters on May 4. Ten days later, two students were killed in a similar incident at Jackson State in Mississippi.